

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — EMPLOYMENT QUANTITY AND JOB QUALITY Mechanism chain: Employment-quality frame - LFPR denominator	02 FOUNDATION — LABOUR-FORCE PARTICIPATION RATE Mechanism chain: Worker-population ratio Qualified use: Trace
03 FOUNDATION — WORKER-POPULATION RATIO Mechanism chain: Unemployment-rate denominator Qualified use:	04 CORE — UNEMPLOYMENT RATE AND DENOMINATOR PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period,
05 CORE — PLFS STATUS AND REFERENCE PERIODS Technically, CORE — PLFS status and reference periods is analysed by	06 CORE — TYPES OF UNEMPLOYMENT Mechanism chain: Human-capital formation - Skill and placement
07 CORE — HUMAN-CAPITAL FORMATION Technically, CORE — Human-capital formation is analysed by relating	08 CORE — SKILL CERTIFICATION AND PLACEMENT Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand
09 CORE — PMKVY AND APPRENTICESHIPS Technically, CORE — PMKVY and apprenticeships is analysed by	10 CORE — DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND Mechanism chain: Female participation and care Qualified use: Begin
11 CORE — FEMALE PARTICIPATION Mechanism chain: Care and monetised economy - Four Labour Codes	12 CORE — CARE ECONOMY AND MONETISED ECONOMY Mechanism chain: Enactment and commencement Qualified use:
13 CORE SYNTHESIS — THE FOUR LABOUR CODES Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS — The four Labour Codes is analysed	14 CORE SYNTHESIS — COMMENCEMENT, RULES AND CONCURRENT-LIST IMPLEMENTATION Mechanism chain: Concurrent-List implementation - Gig and platform
15 CORE SYNTHESIS — GIG WORK, EMPLOYMENT FORMS AND PRODUCTIVITY-LED JOB CREATION □ A person outside the labour force is not counted as unemployed. □	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Employment-quality frame?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: A. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Employment-quality frame?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses Employment-quality frame without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Employment-quality frame?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: D. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies LFPR denominator?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of LFPR denominator?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: B. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses LFPR denominator without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about LFPR denominator?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: D. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Worker-population ratio?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Worker-population ratio?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: B. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Worker-population ratio without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Worker-population ratio?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

Answer: D. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: A. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Unemployment-rate denominator without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: C. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: D. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies PLFS status and reference period?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: A. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PLFS status and reference period?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: B. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses PLFS status and reference period without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PLFS status and reference period?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: D. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Unemployment typology?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: A. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Unemployment typology?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses Unemployment typology without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: C. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Unemployment typology?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: D. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Human-capital formation?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Human-capital formation?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Human-capital formation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: C. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Human-capital formation?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: D. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Skill and placement boundary?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: A. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Skill and placement boundary?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: B. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses Skill and placement boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Skill and placement boundary?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies PMKVY scope?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PMKVY scope?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses PMKVY scope without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PMKVY scope?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: A. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses Apprenticeship mechanism without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: C. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Demographic-dividend condition?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: A. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Demographic-dividend condition?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses Demographic-dividend condition without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: C. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Demographic-dividend condition?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: D. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Female participation and care?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: A. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Female participation and care?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses Female participation and care without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Female participation and care?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Care and monetised economy?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Care and monetised economy?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses Care and monetised economy without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: C. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Care and monetised economy?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Four Labour Codes?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Four Labour Codes?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses Four Labour Codes without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Four Labour Codes?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Enactment and commencement?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: A. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Enactment and commencement?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: B. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses Enactment and commencement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: C. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Enactment and commencement?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Current Labour-Code status?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Current Labour-Code status?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: B. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses Current Labour-Code status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: C. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current Labour-Code status?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Concurrent-List implementation?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: A. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Concurrent-List implementation?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: B. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses Concurrent-List implementation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: C. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Concurrent-List implementation?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Gig and platform work?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Gig and platform work?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses Gig and platform work without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Gig and platform work?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: B. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Fixed-term and casual work boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: D. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Productivity and job creation?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: A. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Productivity and job creation?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: B. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Productivity and job creation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: C. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Productivity and job creation?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: D. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route Mains demands on productivity-led job creation, structural-unemployment measurement, the care economy, Labour Codes, inflation and unemployment, and skill-to-employment linkages, plus objective concepts on human capital, PMKVY, fixed-term work, casual workers and industrial-dispute statistics. No objective key is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May 2026.
- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** merits-consolidation, wider wage/social-security architecture, digital compliance and clarity; risks-thresholds, bargaining power, compliance cost, implementation capacity and gig-worker coverage; conclude with state rules, inspection, grievance redress and measured outcomes.
- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements - answer with the typology unit (frictional/structural/cyclical/seasonal/ disguised) and the PLFS UPS/UPSS-versus-CWS/CDS reference-period distinction above.
- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy - answer with the

Time Use Survey 2019 unpaid-care-work evidence, its exclusion from GDP's production boundary, and the Anganwadi-based formal-care-jobs limitation above.

- ANALYSIS: Demographic-dividend answers should open with the dependency-ratio/window framing above (favourable ratio now, projected to narrow later) rather than treating a young population as an automatic, permanent advantage.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	11	Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 11

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	49	Human capital formation concept and its meaning	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	78	Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	60	Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	58	Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	2	Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; both Economy routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	11	Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	Prelims GS-I	71	Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Both subject routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	11	Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements	Examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	12	Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration	Distinguish · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Human capital formation concept and its meaning
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry
- Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act
- Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends
- Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment
- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion
- Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India

- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment
- Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements
- Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May 2026.

- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** benefits-consolidation, wage coverage, portable protection and compliance clarity; tensions-flexibility versus security, thresholds and bargaining, state capacity, platform-worker implementation and enforcement; assess outcomes rather than enactment alone.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; the stem names both inflation and unemployment	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Social Justice Core route; Economy employment link retained	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Labour-productivity-led growth and the job-creation pattern India should follow.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation

does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation

does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Labour-productivity-led growth and the job-creation pattern India should follow. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III

Demand: Structural unemployment in India and improvements in computation methodology.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

PLFS status and reference period: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Unemployment typology: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

PLFS status and reference period: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Unemployment typology: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Structural unemployment in India and improvements in computation methodology. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a

share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

PLFS status and reference period: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Unemployment typology: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III

Demand: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy and explain their integration.

Status: Official scan wording is recorded as verified in the audited routing ledger.

Model solution: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy and explain their integration. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official scan wording is recorded as verified in the audited routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; current status is separately dated.

Model solution: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Enactment and commencement:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Concurrent-List implementation:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Enactment and commencement: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Concurrent-List implementation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships;

coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; current status is separately dated. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Enactment and commencement: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Concurrent-List implementation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and

therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.
- The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.
- The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.
- PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal

constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.
- Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage,

stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement

boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral

composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.
- Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.
- Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This

identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health,

learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.
- Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.
- Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation....", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet

or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and state capacity. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.
- Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.
- Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.
- Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.
- Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather

than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
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4. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This

identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable protection. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or

accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.
- Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.
- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.
- Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.
- Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can

raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

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Qualified conclusion: Claim: Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion

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Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.